PART 4 OF 11 · LAYER 1: KEEP THE HOUSE DRY

When water gets in

THE SIMPLE VERSION

If something gets wet, dry it fast. Do it today.
If it stays wet for two days, mold can start to grow.

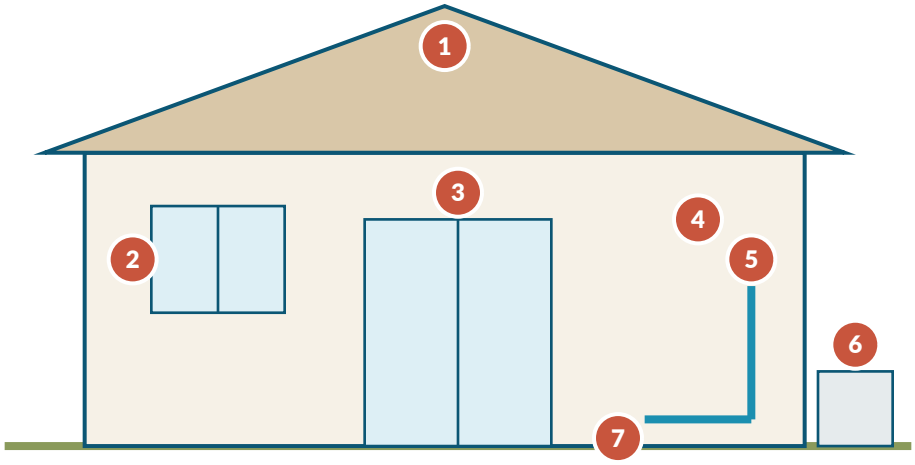


EPA and CDC both advise drying water-damaged areas and items within 24 to 48 hours.[1,2]

- **Treat any water event as urgent.** Stop the source, remove standing water, and run fans and dehumidifiers. If wet materials cannot be dried within 24 to 48 hours, CDC advises assuming mold growth has started.[2]
- **Report early warning signs**: ceiling stains, bubbling paint, swollen baseboards, damp carpet edges, musty odors, or condensation at windows and supply registers.[1]
- **Do not just paint over a stain.** Painting or caulking over mold does not stop it, and the paint is likely to peel.[1]

Where water gets into South Florida homes

In our moisture-intrusion investigations, most problems trace back to a short list of entry points. Water often travels inside a wall before it shows, so the stain is not always where the leak is.



1. Roof, flashing, and roof vents
2. Windows and their frames
3. Sliding doors and storm-shutter tracks
4. Stucco cracks and wall penetrations
5. Plumbing: sinks, toilets, fridge lines
6. AC drain pan, drain line, and coil
7. Ground water, sprinklers, and slab edge

Common water entry points we check during moisture investigations. Inspect these after heavy rain or a storm.

Your next step

If you find active water, stop the source if you safely can, take photos, and start drying within 24 hours. Contact us if the wet area is inside a wall or ceiling, or keeps coming back.

Sources for this part

1. EPA, A Brief Guide to Mold, Moisture and Your Home.
https://www.epa.gov/mold/brief-guide-mold-moisture-and-your-home
2. CDC/EPA/FEMA/HUD/NIH, Homeowner's and Renter's Guide to Mold Cleanup After Disasters.
https://www.cdc.gov/mold/pdfs/Homeowners_and_Renters_Guide.pdf